

Chapter – 10: Grassroots Democracy – Part 1 – Governance

“rājānam dharmagoptāram dharmo rakṣhati rakṣhitah” “The ruler protects dharma and dharma protects those who protect it.” – The Mahābhārata

“There is no peace without justice; no justice without equality; no equality without development; no democracy without respect to the identity and dignity of cultures and peoples.” – Rigoberta Menchú Tum

Introduction

- Humans – living in communities – long time
- Large no. of people – live together – disagreements, disorders – rules – necessary – maintain order, harmony
 - At home – simple rules – you follow
 - At school – rules – some for students – some for teachers
 - Higher classes – students – taking exams – follow some rules
 - Drivers on roads – obey traffic rules
 - People – employee – follow employer’s rules – EVEN – employers – follow rules – committed to employees
- If no rules – society – won’t func.
- This chapter – who make rules? – how are rules made?
- Process – taking decisions, organizing society life – diff. set of rules – ensuring they are followed – **governance**
- Grp. of individuals – system – makes the rules – **govt.**
- Some rules – more imp. – **laws**
- Rules and laws – not fixed
 - At home – discuss with parents – certain rules
 - At school – student body – discuss with school management
- Same way – citizens – discuss laws and rules – govern society

3 Organs of Govt.

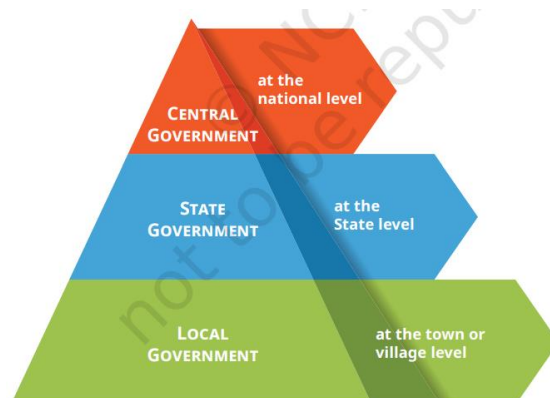
- All over world – digital tech. – transform – how societies func.
- India – till 30 yrs. ago –
 - People wanted – transfer money – distant rel. – queue up – Post Office – send money order
 - People wanted – transfer money – some business – go to bank – obtain demand draft – send by post
- Today – digital means – sending money – instantly
- This also created – new criminals – find digital ways – stealing money
- Many govt. – pass new laws – fight such criminals – (cybercrime)
- Some criminals – believe – robbing people – much better than – using skills to earn money – punished by govt. – fine or jail or both
- This example – shows – 3 organs of govt. – work together
 - **Legislature** – makes new laws – updates them – removes them – done by – assembly of representatives

- **Executive** – implements laws – including head of state (President, Prime Minister or Chief Minister), ministers and agencies – enforcing law and order
- **Judiciary** – sys. of courts – decides – if law is broken or not – if broken, what is the punishment – sometimes – also examines – decisions by executive – laws made – right or wrong
- Good sys. of governance – 3 organs – kept separate – BUT ALSO – interact with each other – **separation of power**
- This provides – sys. of balance
- Each organ of govt. – check – what other is doing – restore balance – if necessary



3 Levels of Govt.

- Any govt. – 2 levels at least – local and national
- Many countries – incl. India – 3 levels (tiers) – local, state (regional), national
- Each level – deals – diff. matters
- Example – Bulb – at home – does not work –
 - 1st check – bulb, switch, fuse, etc
 - That does not work – call an electrician
 - That also does not work – file complaint – electricity board
- India – local govt., State govt., Central (Union) govt.
- Example – heavy rain – few days –
 - Flood – not too severe – local govt. handles it
 - Flood involves multiple towns, villages – State govt. – steps in – sends rescue teams
 - Flood – very massive – affects vast areas – Central govt. – step in – rescue teams, relief supplies, etc.
- Following table – summary – general framework – main func. – govt.'s 3 organs – national and state level



	All India	State Level
Judiciary	Supreme Court of India	High Court
	National Level	State Level
Legislature	2 houses – Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha – formulate national laws	1 state assembly – Vidhan Sabha (some states – 2 assemblies)
	Central Govt.	State Govt.
Executive	Leader – President of India (nominal head, commander of Indian armed forces), Prime Minister – executive head	Leader – Governor (nominal head), Chief Minister – executive head

Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

- Birth – humble family – Rameswaram, Tamil Nadu – 1931
- Dr. Kalam – renowned scientist – nicknamed – Missile Man of India – crucial role – development – India's space, missile and nuclear programmes

- Dr. Kalam – 11th President of India – 2002 to 2007
- Always connected – deeply – with people – specially youths – his passion – education and innovation
- He inspired millions – his humility, dedication – social causes – commitment to nation
- Encouraged young Indians – dream big – work hard – achieve goals

Democracy

- Earlier mentioned – representatives of people – foundation stones – sys. of governance – adopted by most countries – **democracy**
- Democracy – rule of the people – 2 Greek words – *demos* meaning people – *kratos* meaning rule
- All people – rule together – not possible
- Example –
 - Your class – some problem – entire class – go to principal – not practical
 - Many schools – class monitor – elected by all students – send to principal
- Same principle – state, national levels – elections – people vote – **representatives** – elected members – respective assemblies
- Generally called –
 - **Members of Legislative Assembly** (MLAs) – state level
 - **Member of Parliament** (MPs) – national level
- All these members – discuss laws, problems, solutions – through dialogue and debate
- India – **representative democracy** – world's largest democracy – 970 million voters – 2024
- All Indian citizens – above 18 yrs. – right to participate – elections
- Imagine –
 - Your class – going for picnic – 2 possible places – A and B
 - Class discusses – pros and cons – dist., time, cost, basic facilities, etc.
 - Very difficult – arrive at decision – teacher decides – voting – solve problem
 - Students – favor A – raise hands – then – students – favor B – raise hands
 - Decision – which option – larger no. of hands
 - This case – **direct democracy** – every student's opinion – taken to finalise
- Term **grassroots democracy** – sys. – enables, encourages – participation of ordinary citizens